



GUIDE: COMPLETING THE BIOSAFETY PERMIT FORM (LEVEL 1 & 2)

Instructions:

- Adhering to the instructions for completing the permit form is crucial to ensure a smooth review process and to avoid delays resulting from unclear or insufficient information.
- Ensure that you are using the **July 2025 version of the BIOSAFETY PERMIT APPLICATION FORM (Level 1 & 2)**.
- The application package consists of the permit application form and 4 subforms:
 1. [Assessment for Potential on Dual-Use](#)
 2. [Description of Research Activities](#)
 3. [Biosafety Information](#)
 4. [Viral Vectors](#)
- **Note for Mac users:** use 'Adobe reader for Mac' for all PDF form filling and editing. Do not use Preview, which is usually the default program to open PDFs on Macs.

Section	Information Required	Notes
Section A	PI Contact Information	• Complete all sections • 24-hour emergency phone number is required for PI
Section B	Principal Lab Contact	• To be contacted in case of permit related questions • 24-hour emergency phone number is required
Section C	Application Type	• New - first time applying • Renewal - renewal of a previous biosafety permit
	Permit Type	• Select as applicable
Section D	Permit Level	• Level 1 – if Risk group 1 material is in use and only containment level 1 spaces are used • Level 2 – if Risk group 2 biological material is in use and/or containment level 2 spaces are used
Section E	Funding Information	• List all current funding associated with the research activities outlined on the permit.
Section F	Project Locations	• List as applicable to indicate where work is conducted and/or biological material is stored. Include shared spaces.
Section G	Biological Safety Cabinets	• List all BSCs in use (including those that are shared)
Section H	Lab Personnel	• List only the personnel who are currently working with biological agents, plan to work with them, or will be entering containment level 1 or 2 spaces. • Complete all fields for each person working in the lab.

Section	Information Required	Notes
		Please ensure all required training (EHS) is up-to-date all times.
Section I	Animal and Radioisotope Usage	Select as applicable to your research activities.
Section J	Other Permits	Other permits include ethics approvals for human studies, regulatory agency approvals, etc.
Section K-I	Biological Agent Categories	- Check all applicable bioagent categories. NOTE: this section and K-II MUST correspond
Section K-II	Biological Agent List	- List ALL biological agents (and biological toxins) that will be used in the projects - Most risk groups can be found at https://health.canada.ca/en/epathogen. Note that EHS must follow PHAC guidance on risk group designation, even if this differs from other sources. NOTE: stored biological agents (which will not be used in the duration of the permit life) must be listed in Appendix VI Note: Listing of HPTA exempt cell lines You do not need to list all of modified/derivative cell lines if you have the parent cell line on your permit unless in the following situations: - you have introduced something that is regulated by CFIA (e.g., a potential animal pathogen, zoonotic pathogen or part thereof) - you have introduced something that has the potential to alter the pathogenicity of the parent cell line in any way (e.g., introduced a toxin, altered tropism etc.). - if you need an import permit or BATN; then it must be specifically listed on the permit in the event of an audit (it can be added to the permit via an amendment at that time).
Section K-III	Assessment on the Potential for Dual-Use	Follow instructions provided in the Dual-Use Assessment subform.
Section M	Medical Surveillance	Answer all questions
Section N	Declarations	- Please sign and date the application form - Obtain your Chair/Dean's signature as applicable
Appendix I	Additional Space for Section E	Use this section only if additional space is needed beyond Section E. Do not duplicate information already provided in Section E.
Appendix III	Additional Space for Section H	Use this section only if additional space is needed beyond Section H. Do not duplicate information already provided in Section H.

Section	Information Required	Notes
Appendix IV–A	Research Activities Involving Biological Agents	- Fill out the Research Activities subform. Fill one subform for each project in your research program. - Detailed instructions are provided in the subform. Please refer to the additional guidance provided after this table for details on the type of information required for specific bioagents.
Appendix IV–B		- Fill out the Biosafety Information subform. Fill one subform for all biological agents and research activities listed on the permit. - Detailed instructions are provided in the subform.
Appendix IV–C	Research Activities involving Viral Vectors	- Fill out the Viral Vectors subform provided in this application package. Fill one subform for each viral vector system used. - Detailed instructions are provided in the subform.
Appendix V	Additional Space for Section K-II – Materials in Use	Use this section only if additional space is needed beyond Section K. Do not duplicate information already provided in Section K.
Appendix VI	Stored Biological Materials	- List ALL biological materials that are stored and not expected to be used during the permit’s duration. NOTE: When you wish to start using any of the stored materials, you will need to submit an amendment for review and approval before the work can begin.
Appendix VII	Provisions for Viable Human Pathogens	- This section serves as a reference for lab members to understand the associated risks, appropriate decontamination procedures, and emergency response measures. - For viable pathogenic Risk Group 2 material, complete all rows TIPS: - Specify the concentration and contact time used for the mode of decontamination - Provide references

Additional information required for certain biological agents – to be included in the description section of the Research Activities Subform

Human tissues, fluids, primary cells

- 1) Source of samples: describe the population that the samples are from and any associated risks. Is the population generally healthy? Was the population screened? Is the population known to have pathogens for example are they all positive for HIV?
- 2) Have the samples been screened for blood borne pathogens? For what pathogens? If screened include certification of screening with permit application.
- 3) What volume will be handled? Risk increases with large volumes.

Animal work in conjunction with biological agents

- 1) species
- 2) source of the animals – i.e. commercial vendor, in-house, from another institution, pet-trade, wild-caught, or other – describe.
- 3) if wild-caught, provide geographical location
- 4) if from pet-trade, wild-caught or other source, list potential zoonoses

Toxins

- 1) Briefly describe what you will use the toxin for and how you will use the toxin.

Crispr/Cas9 systems

Crispr systems are not currently being tracked in our biosafety permits but due to possible regulatory implications we are asking researchers that are or are planning to use Crispr/Cas9 to send us answers to the following questions:

- 1) Target genes? - Germ lines or somatic cells?
- 2) Nature of insert
- 3) Vector?
- 4) Is the guide RNA and the Crispr together or separate?
- 5) Is the system dead ended or continuous?

If you are not yet working with Crispr/Cas9 systems, but decide to during the duration of your permit, please send an email to the ehs.biosafety@utoronto.ca informing us of the proposed work and answering the above questions.